

Based on Dr Kristin Neff's Self-Compassion Framework

Self-compassion is treating yourself with the same kindness you would offer a good friend in distress. Research shows it is strongly associated with emotional resilience, lower anxiety and depression, and healthier relationships.

The Three Components

Component	Description	Reflective Question
Self-Kindness vs Self-Judgment	Being warm and understanding with yourself when you're struggling.	"What would I say to a dear friend in this situation?"
Common Humanity vs Isolation	Recognising that suffering is part of the shared human experience.	"Who else might be feeling this way right now?"
Mindfulness vs Over-Identification	Noticing painful feelings in balanced awareness, without getting swept away by them.	"Can I observe this feeling without being swept away by it?"

Exercise 1: The Self-Compassion Letter

Think of something causing shame or self-judgment. Write a letter to yourself as a compassionate friend who knows you well. Include: (1) acknowledgment of your pain, (2) reminder that suffering is human, (3) warmth and encouragement.

With compassion,
[your name]

Exercise 2: Tracking Self-Critical Thoughts (1 Week)

Self-Critical Thought	Emotion (0-10)	Compassionate Reframe	Emotion After (0-10)

Exercise 3: The Self-Compassion Break

Use this 3-step practice any time you are struggling. It takes 1-2 minutes:

Step 1 Mindfulness	"This is a moment of suffering." or "This really hurts right now."
Step 2 Common Humanity	"Suffering is a part of life. I am not alone in feeling this."
Step 3 Self-Kindness	Place a hand on your heart: "May I be kind to myself. May I give myself the compassion I need."

Daily Self-Compassion Check-In (2 Weeks)

Date	Difficult moment today	How I treated myself	SC Break used? Y/N	Rating (1-10)